EXPLORER ACTIVITY & REWARDS PACK

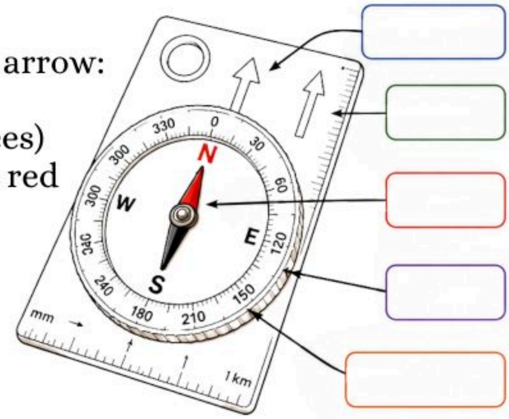
Map • Compass • Navigation • Adventure

PART 1: PRACTICE

Activity:
Label Your Compass Diagram!

1. Copy or print the diagram of a compass.

2. Write each part's name next to its arrow:
   - Baseplate
   - Bezel (rotating dial with degrees)
   - Compass Needle (magnetized, red end for north)
   - Orienting Arrow
   - Direction-of-Travel Arrow



3. Color each part in a different shade to help you remember.

4. Under each name, write one simple sentence about what it does.

5. Keep your labeled diagram in your adventure notebook.

	Part Name	What does it do?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

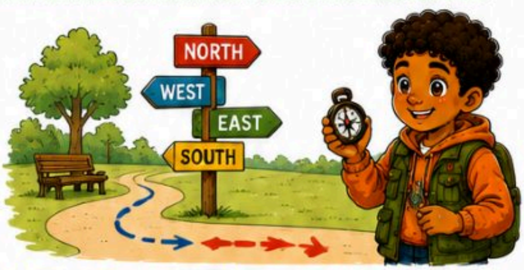
This fun activity puts your new knowledge into action and gets you ready for real-life exploration.

Explore with Your New Compass

Now that you have made your own compass, try these fun ideas:

1. Backyard Treasure Hunt: Draw a simple map of your yard. Use your compass to set a direction. Hide a small toy at a bearing of 45° or 135°, and ask a friend to find it.

2. Park Walk: Take your compass to the park. Find north, south, east, and west. Then walk ten steps east,
turn south, and walk again. See where you end up.



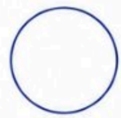
3. Sun and Compass: Watch how the sun moves. In the morning, it is in the east. At noon, it is in the south (if you live in the Northern Hemisphere). Compare the sun's path with your compass directions.

4. Compass Relay: Play a game with friends. One friend hides a small marker and gives a compass bearing. Others use their homemade compasses to find it. The fastest finder wins.

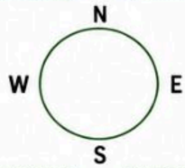
Activity: Draw Your Own Compass Rose!

Grab a clean sheet of paper and your favorite pencil or crayons. Let's make a compass rose together.

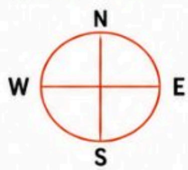
1. **Draw a big circle.** Use a cup or a lid to trace a round circle. That is your compass frame.



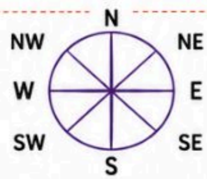
2. **Mark the four big directions.** At the top, write N. On the right, write E. At the bottom, write S. On the left, write W.



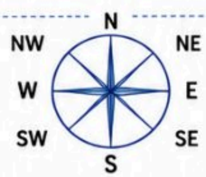
3. **Draw the big points.** From the center of the circle, draw four straight lines to each letter. Make these lines long, they are the big direction points.



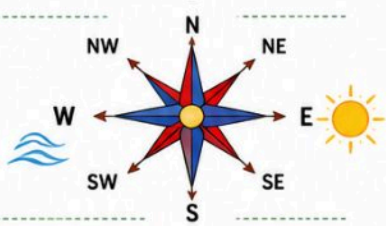
4. **Add the in-between directions.** Halfway between N and E, write NE. Between E and S, write SE. Between S and W, write SW. Between W and N, write NW.



5. **Draw the small points.** From the center, draw four shorter lines to each in-between letter. These are the smaller points of your star.



6. **Decorate it.** Color the big points one color and the small points another. Add a sun icon near East or a wave near West. Draw small arrows along each line if you like.



7. **Name your compass rose.** Give it a fun name like "Champs' North Star" or "Adventure Wheel."

My Compass Rose Name: ______________________

Draw Your Compass Rose Here!

Use this space to draw your very own compass rose.
Make it colorful, creative, and uniquely yours!

Practice Games and Challenges

Now that you have learned the directions and made your compass rose, let's play some games!

1. Direction Tag. One player is "It." They call out a direction, for example, "Go North!" Everyone else runs to face North and freezes. The last one to face the right way is "It" next.

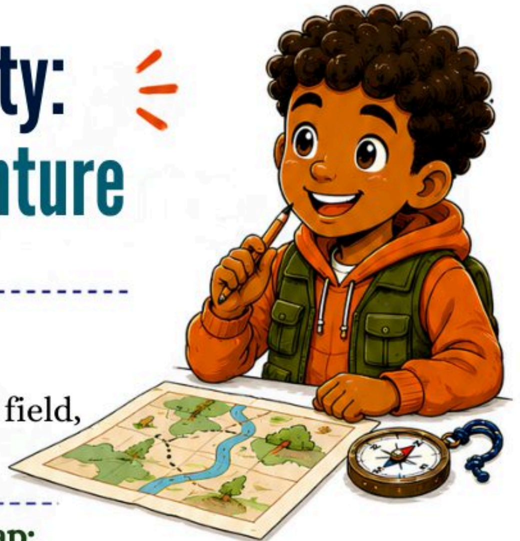
2. Blindfold Turn. One player is blindfolded, and a partner gently turns them in a circle. The partner calls "Stop!" The blindfolded player points the way they think is East. Then they check with a compass to see if they were right.

3. Indoor Treasure Hunt. Hide a small toy in your house. Write clues using directions: "Take 5 steps North from the couch. Turn West." Let a friend follow the clues to find the treasure.

4. Outdoor Explorer Trail. In your backyard or park, set markers at different compass bearings. For example, walk Northeast 10 paces to a flag, then Southwest 5 paces. Draw a map of your trail using your compass rose.

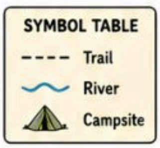
Each game helps you get better at using directions. The more you practice, the easier it gets. Soon you will know the eight points without even thinking!

Practice Activity:
Plan a Mini Adventure



1.  **Choose a location:**
your backyard, school field, or local park.

2.  **Draw a simple map:**
sketch the area on paper, mark a starting point with an X, and draw a trail to a fun spot (a tree, bench, or rock).

3. 

Add symbols:
use the symbol table to add a trail, river, and campsite, and create a legend box on the side.

4. 

Make a compass rose:
draw a small one in the corner with N, E, S, W.

5.  **Set bearings:**
place your real compass on the map along the path line, turn the bezel so the orienting arrow matches map north, and read the bearing.

6.  **Follow the plan:**
go outside, find north, orient your map, follow the bearing, look for the symbols you drew, and reach your destination.

This exercise shows you how maps and compasses work together. You'll learn to trust your skills and have fun exploring!

Activity: Measure Distance on Your Map!

Grab any map you have, a road map, a topo map, or a park map.

Materials:

. a map with a bar scale or a ratio scale

. a ruler or a piece of paper

. pencil and paper to record your answers.

1. Pick two points:

your house and the playground, or two trailheads on a park map.

2. Choose your scale

find the bar scale or the ratio scale on your map.

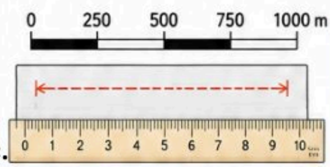
BAR SCALE

RATIO SCALE

1 : 25,000

3. Measure with a bar scale:

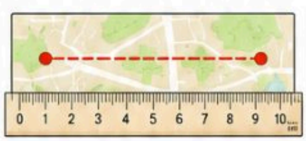
use the ruler/paper method, count how many segments fit, and calculate the real distance.



Example:
6.5 segments
x 250 m =
1625 m = 1.625 km

4. Measure with a ratio scale:

measure the line with your ruler, multiply by the map's ratio number, and convert to meters or kilometers.



Example:
line = 5.2 cm
5.2 x 25,000 = 130,000 cm
= 1300 m = 1.3 km

5. Compare results:

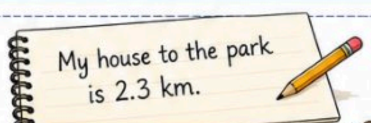
if you used both scales, check that your answers match, they should be very close.

My Results

Bar scale: 1.625 km
Ratio scale: 1.3 km
Very close! ✓

6. Write it down:

"My house to the park is 2.3 km."

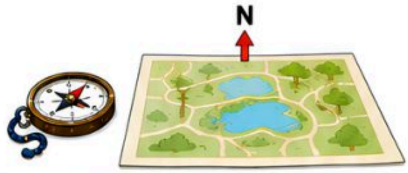


You did it! You measured real distances with your map skills. Practice with different points until you feel great at it.

Activity:
Triangulation Practice in a Park!

Grab your map, compass, and a friend.
Find three landmarks in the park (a big tree, a bench, a trash can) that are marked on your map.

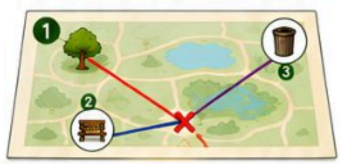
1. Orient your map using your compass.



2. Take a bearing to Landmark 1 and record it.

3. Place your compass on the map at Landmark 1. Rotate map and compass until the needle matches the orienting arrow. Draw a line.

4. Repeat for Landmark 2, and Landmark 3 if you like.



5. Find your spot where the lines cross. Mark "X", this is You Are Here!

Check in real life: walk to a nearby bench or tree. Are you right? High-five!
You just navigated with map and compass.

Activity:
Set Up a Mini Orienteering Course!

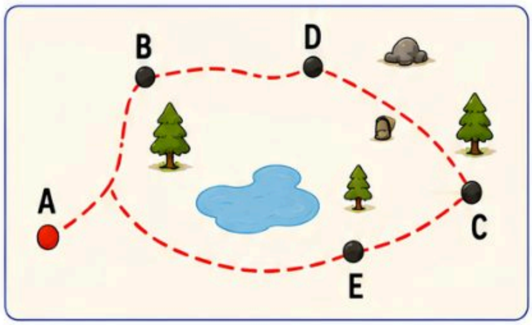
What you need:

a simple map of your field or backyard (drawn on paper)

a compass for each player

small flags or markers for checkpoints

1. Draw your course map.



Sketch the main area with a starting point marked "A." Add 4-6 checkpoints labeled B, C, D, and so on. Draw simple shapes for trees or big rocks.

2. Place the markers.

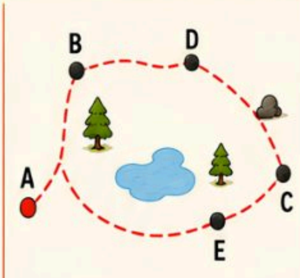
In the real area, put small flags or cones at each checkpoint.

3. Write bearings and distances.

On your map, next to each letter, write the bearing and distance from the previous point. For example,

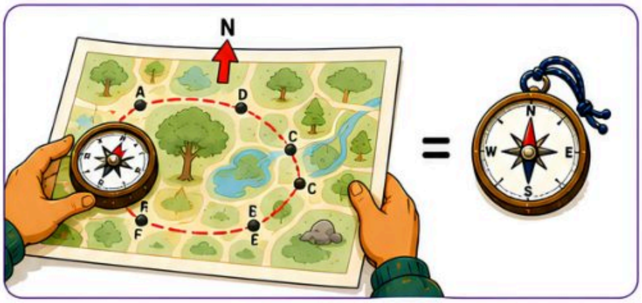
A to B: 120° / 20 paces.
B to C: 200°/15 paces.

A → B:	120° / 20 paces
B → C:	200° / 15 paces
C → D:	080° / 18 paces
D → E:	160° / 22 paces
E → F:	300° / 16 paces
F → A:	340° / 25 paces



Activity:
Set Up a Mini Orienteering Course!

4. Orient your map.
Before you start, hold your compass on the map and rotate both until the needle matches the orienting arrow.



5. Follow the course.
From A, set your compass to the bearing you wrote, walk the correct number of paces, look for marker B, and check it off. Then set your next bearing. Continue until you reach all markers.

6. Finish and check!
Return to point A and compare your time or number of mistakes.

Team play idea:
Split into teams, each with a map and compass.
Race to see who completes the course first with no errors!

Game: Compass Relay Races!

What you need:

two compasses (one per team)

two identical maps

4-5 relay points marked with cones or flags.

1. Form teams.

Split into two equal teams. Each team lines up at the start; the first player is ready at point 1.

2. Set the first bearing.

Team leaders tell players the first bearing and distance, for example, 60° / 10 paces to cone 1.

3. Go!

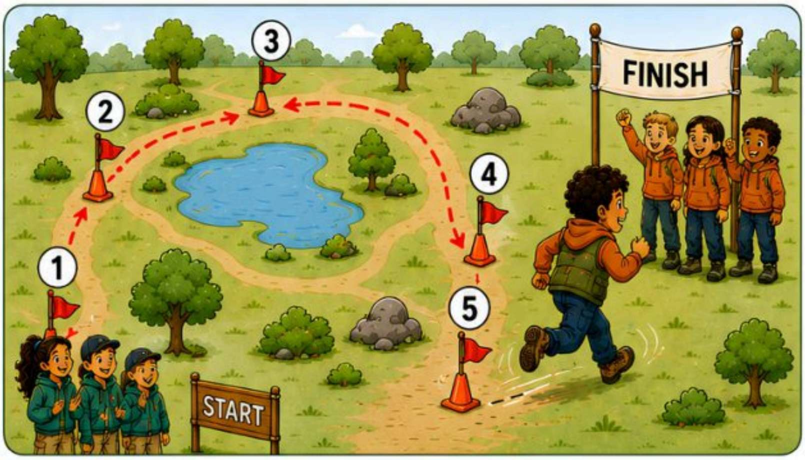
At "Go," the first player from each team sets the compass and runs to cone 1. They tag the cone and run back.

4. Next runner.

The tagged runner passes the compass to the next teammate, who navigates to point 2.

5. Continue the race.

Keep going until all cones are tagged. The last runner sprints back to the start.

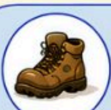


Winning the race:

The first team to finish with correct bearings and tags wins. If a runner tags the wrong cone, they must run back and find the correct one.

Fair play:

- Don't push or trip teammates.
- Stay in the relay area.
- Cheer each other on!



Relay races make compass practice fast and fun, you learn under pressure and get great exercise.

Challenge:
Plan an Imaginary Wilderness Journey!

What you need:

a real or made-up map with hills, rivers, and forests

paper and pencil

1. Pick your map..

Use a real topographic map or draw your own island map

OR

2. Mark your start.

Choose a point and label it "Start."

3. Choose your landmarks.

Mark 4-5 places: campsite, river crossing, hilltop, waterfall.

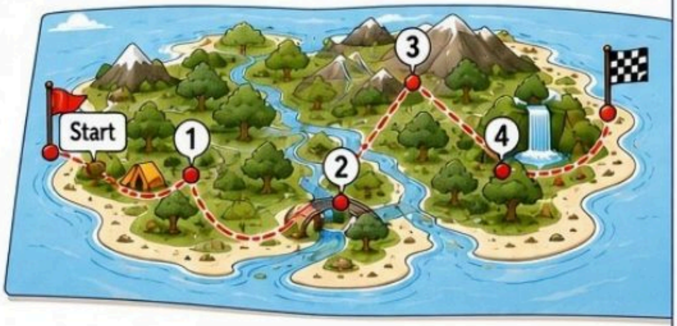
4. Draw your route.

Connect Start → Landmark 1 → Landmark 2 → ... → Final Spot.

5. Write bearings & distances.

For each line, note the bearing in degrees and the distance in paces or kilometers, for example, 45° / 1 km.

Leg	Bearing	Distance
Start → 1	045°	1 km
1 → 2	090°	2 km
2 → 3	135°	1.5 km
3 → 4	210°	2.5 km
4 → Final	300°	1 km



6. List supplies & hazards.

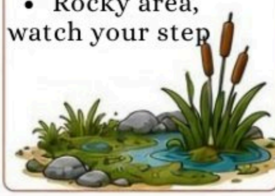
Write what gear you need (water bottle, boots, hat) and note any dangers ("Swamp at 90°, slow crossing").

Supplies

- Water bottle
- Hiking boots
- Hat
- Map
- Compass
- Snack

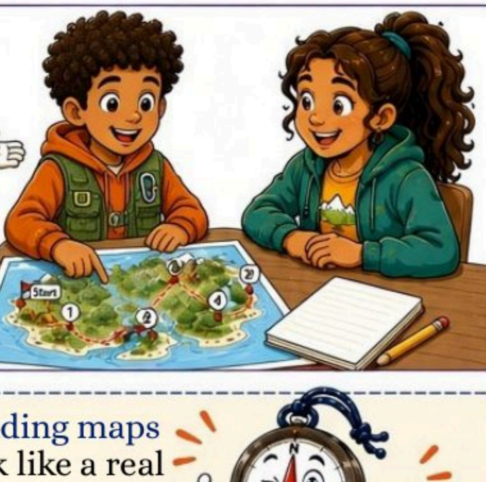
Hazards

- Swamp at 90°, slow crossing
- Steep hill at 210°
- Strong current at river crossing
- Rocky area, watch your step



7. Share your plan.

Present your journey to friends or family, explaining the bearings, distances, and why you picked each spot.



This helps you practice reading maps and writing bearings, think like a real explorer, and build planning and storytelling skills!

Quiz Box:
Test Your Map & Compass Skills!

Circle the right answer or write True (T) or False (F).

1. To orient a map, you match its north to the red end of your compass needle. (T / F)

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2. A bearing of 180° means you walk south. (T / F)

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3. In triangulation, you use two or more bearings to find your position. (T / F)

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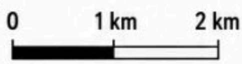
4. A bar scale shows 0, 1 km, 2 km, and you use a ruler or paper to measure. (T / F)



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5. To follow a bearing, you hold the compass flat, turn your body so the red needle enters the orienting arrow, and walk along the travel arrow. (T / F)

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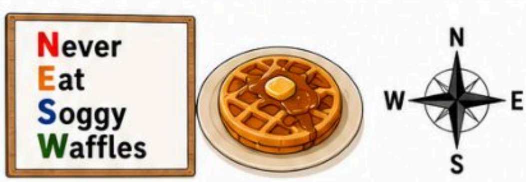
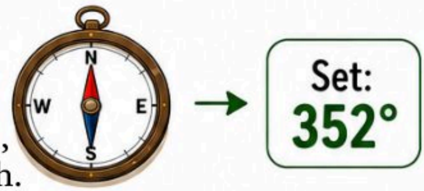
6. The mnemonic "Never Eat Soggy Waffles" helps you remember North, East, South, West in order. (T / F)



Practice: Calculating Declination

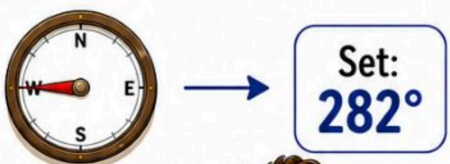
1. Let's try a quick practice. Your map says declination is 8°E, and you want to head true north (0°).

2. Subtract 8° from 0°. But 0° minus 8° wraps around to 352° (because 360° is the same as 0°). So you set 352° on your compass, and now you will walk true north.



3. Another example: declination is 12°W and you want to go true bearing 270° (west).

4. Add 12° to 270° to get 282°. Set your compass to 282° to walk true west.



5. Write a few problems on paper. Practice adding or subtracting declination with different bearings. Soon you'll do it in your head without thinking!

Activity: Interview a Compass Pro!

Talking to someone who uses a compass every day is fun. Pick a hiker, a scout leader, or a park ranger. Ask questions like:

1. What is your favorite compass trick?

2. How did you learn to use a compass?

3. Can you show me your you compass and map?

4. What was the hardest place you navigated?

5. What advice do you have for young explorers?

Write down their answers in your notebook.

You'll learn new tips and make a new mentor!

PART 2: ACTIVITIES AND PRIZES

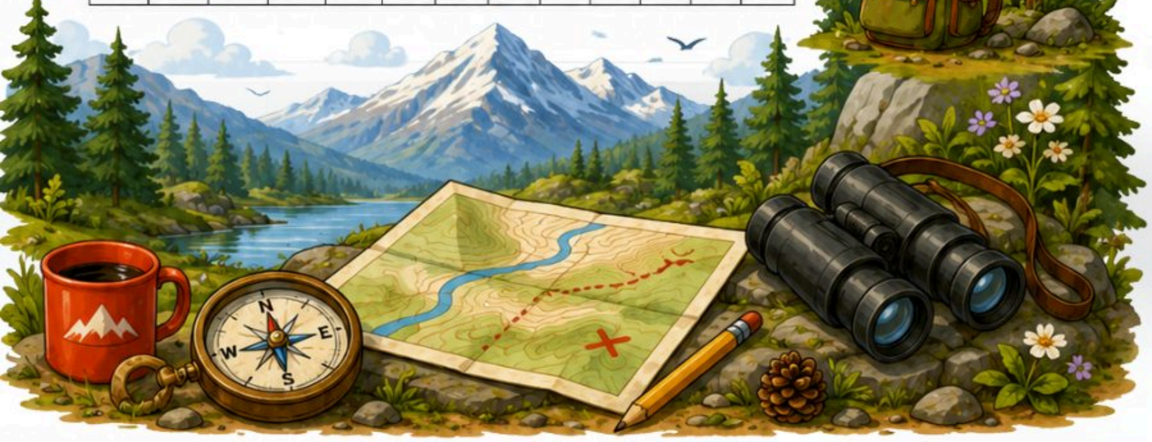
Word Search : Compass Basics

Find the hidden words in the puzzle.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
1	C	C	H	T	U	O	S	T	S	E	W	A	O
2	A	Y	Y	I	H	I	D	H	Z	T	F	L	J
3	C	F	F	I	Q	F	T	V	I	U	W	J	O
4	W	K	P	P	D	R	A	J	M	K	N	Z	G
5	I	B	D	I	O	X	Q	G	T	N	A	H	A
6	M	A	E	N	B	X	F	O	A	W	Q	V	N
7	R	S	H	U	Z	W	B	E	A	R	I	N	G
8	Q	E	O	B	E	Z	E	L	H	Q	R	U	A
9	M	P	V	M	A	G	N	E	T	S	Z	O	K
10	V	L	U	N	B	X	J	E	G	B	J	C	W
11	C	A	J	J	X	F	N	S	I	E	A	R	B
12	S	T	G	S	O	F	Y	N	E	E	D	L	E
13	W	E	T	E	A	S	T	Q	B	M	G	L	D

Find:

- NORTH
- SOUTH
- EAST
- WEST
- NEEDLE
- BEZEL
- BASEPLATE
- BEARING
- MAGNET
- ARROW



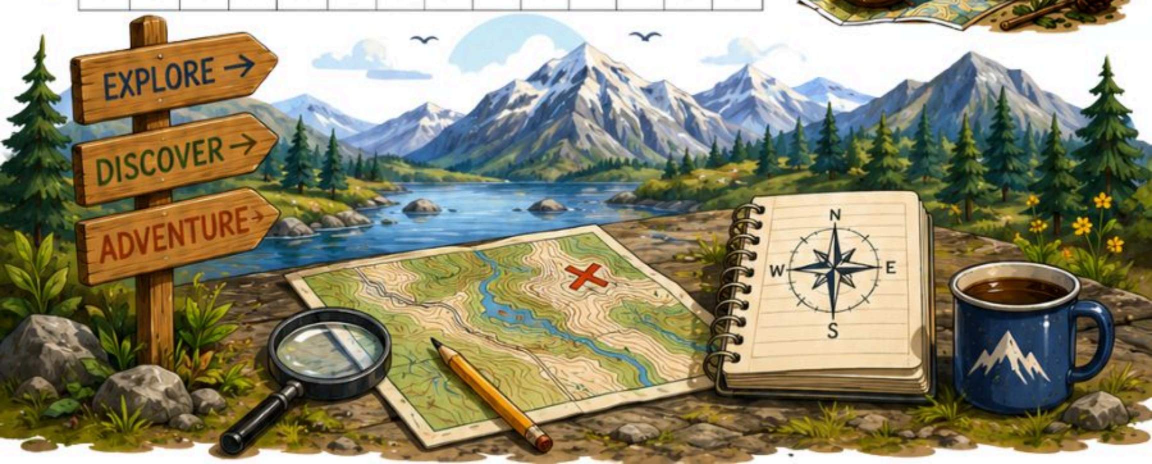
Word Search:
Maps & Navigation

Find the hidden words in the puzzle.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
1	A	T	N	E	I	R	O	Z	D	H	U	F	R	S
2	F	C	Z	R	Z	I	B	N	V	C	C	A	O	A
3	Y	Y	I	H	E	I	E	D	K	Z	S	T	F	L
4	J	C	F	T	F	G	I	R	Q	F	Y	V	I	U
5	W	J	U	O	E	W	A	K	P	P	M	D	A	J
6	M	O	K	L	N	M	Z	G	I	P	B	D	Y	X
7	R	Q	G	T	D	N	A	H	A	A	O	M	E	B
8	X	F	O	N	W	Q	V	N	C	M	L	R	H	U
9	Z	W	A	C	O	N	T	O	U	R	Q	O	H	Q
10	U	L	A	M	V	S	M	Z	K	V	U	N	B	X
11	J	E	G	B	J	P	C	C	J	J	X	F	N	S
12	I	E	E	T	A	L	U	G	N	A	I	R	T	A
13	R	B	S	S	C	A	L	E	G	S	O	F	Y	W
14	T	Q	S	B	M	G	L	D	G	S	V	N	S	G

Find:

- MAP
- SCALE
- LEGEND
- CONTOUR
- LANDMARK
- ORIENT
- SYMBOL
- COMPASS
- ROUTE
- TRIANGULATE



Word Search : Outdoor Explorer

Find the hidden words in the puzzle.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
1	E	S	I	R	N	U	S	X	Z	M	N	V	F	L
2	R	W	Y	V	X	L	W	O	D	A	H	S	C	O
3	V	Q	D	Y	F	Q	M	L	P	X	A	P	B	J
4	W	T	S	S	M	U	S	F	F	Q	H	A	Y	G
5	R	E	R	H	M	Q	L	I	S	L	L	O	I	V
6	R	X	T	X	A	M	Z	X	R	R	I	Q	Z	E
7	Q	P	Y	R	G	N	B	P	L	A	E	A	S	R
8	G	L	Q	G	E	A	R	N	P	L	L	T	R	N
9	L	O	A	S	H	E	L	T	E	R	R	O	A	T
10	R	R	T	Z	T	K	O	T	A	Z	H	U	P	W
11	F	E	R	S	F	C	Z	R	Z	I	B	V	C	C
12	A	R	O	A	Y	Y	I	W	H	I	S	T	L	E
13	H	I	D	Z	T	F	L	J	C	F	F	I	Q	F
14	V	I	U	W	J	O	B	A	C	K	P	A	C	K

Find:

- POLARIS
- SHADOW
- WHISTLE
- SHELTER
- TRAIL
- WATER
- GEAR
- EXPLORER
- SUNRISE
- BACKPACK

WORD SEARCH SOLUTIONS

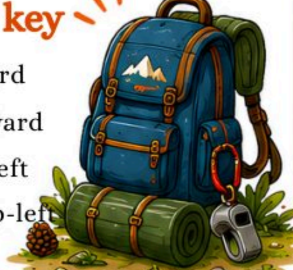
1 Word Search 1: Compass Basics Answer key

- NORTH: r6 c4 diag up-right
- SOUTH: r1 c7 backward
- EAST: r13 c4 right
- WEST: r1 c11 backward
- NEEDLE: r12 c8 right
- BEZEL: r8 c4 right
- BASEPLATE: r5 c2 down
- BEARING: r7 c7 right
- MAGNET: r9 c4 right
- ARROW: r6 c9 diag down-right

2 Word Search 2: Maps & Navigation Answer key

- MAP: r8 c10 up
- SCALE: r13 c4 right
- LEGEND: r6 c4 diag up-right
- CONTOUR: r9 c4 right
- LANDMARK: r10 c2 diag up-right
- ORIENT: r1 c7 backward
- SYMBOL: r3 c11 down
- COMPASS: r8 c9 diag down-left
- ROUTE: r7 c1 diag up-right
- TRIANGULATE: r12 c13 backward

3 Word Search 3: Outdoor Explorer Answer key



- EXPLORER: r5 c2 down
- BACKPACK: r14 c7 right
- POLARIS: r10 c13 diag up-left
- WHISTLE: r12 c8 right
- SHELTER: r9 c4 right
- SUNRISE: r1 c7 backward
- SHADOW: r2 c12 backward
- TRAIL: r9 c14 diag up-left
- WATER: r10 c14 diag up-left
- GEAR: r8 c4 right

OFFICIAL EXPLORER HERO

CERTIFICATE

This certifies that

____

(write your name)

has mastered the Compass, the Map,
and Outdoor Survival Skills,
and is now a true

Explorer Hero!

Draw your
favorite compass
rose here!

Awarded on: ______________ **Signed:** ________________

(Chief Explorer)

Fun Books Publisher

How to Use a Compass for Kids

Explorer ID Card

A small card the child fills in and cuts out.

EXPLORER ID CARD

Name: ______________________________

Explorer since: ____________________

Favorite place to explore: ____________________________________

My compass mascot: (draw or color)

Rank:

- ☐ Trailblazer
- ☐ Pathfinder
- ☐ Explorer Hero

"Always find your way."

Fun Books Publisher

The Explorer's Oath

I promise to explore with curiosity and courage.

I will keep my compass close and my map ready.

I will respect nature and leave no trace.

I will stay safe, tell someone my plan, and never give up.

With north in my heart,
I am ready for adventure!

Signed, Explorer ______________________

Themed Maze

Help the mascot follow the trail from the campsite to the hidden waterfall.

Explorer Tip: Look carefully, the right path will lead you to a great discovery!

MY ADVENTURE LOG

Date: ____________________ Where I explored: ________________________________

The weather was: □ sunny □ cloudy □ rainy □ snowy

North was toward: ____________________ My bearing to my goal: __________°

Cool things I found: ____

____

A landmark I used: ____

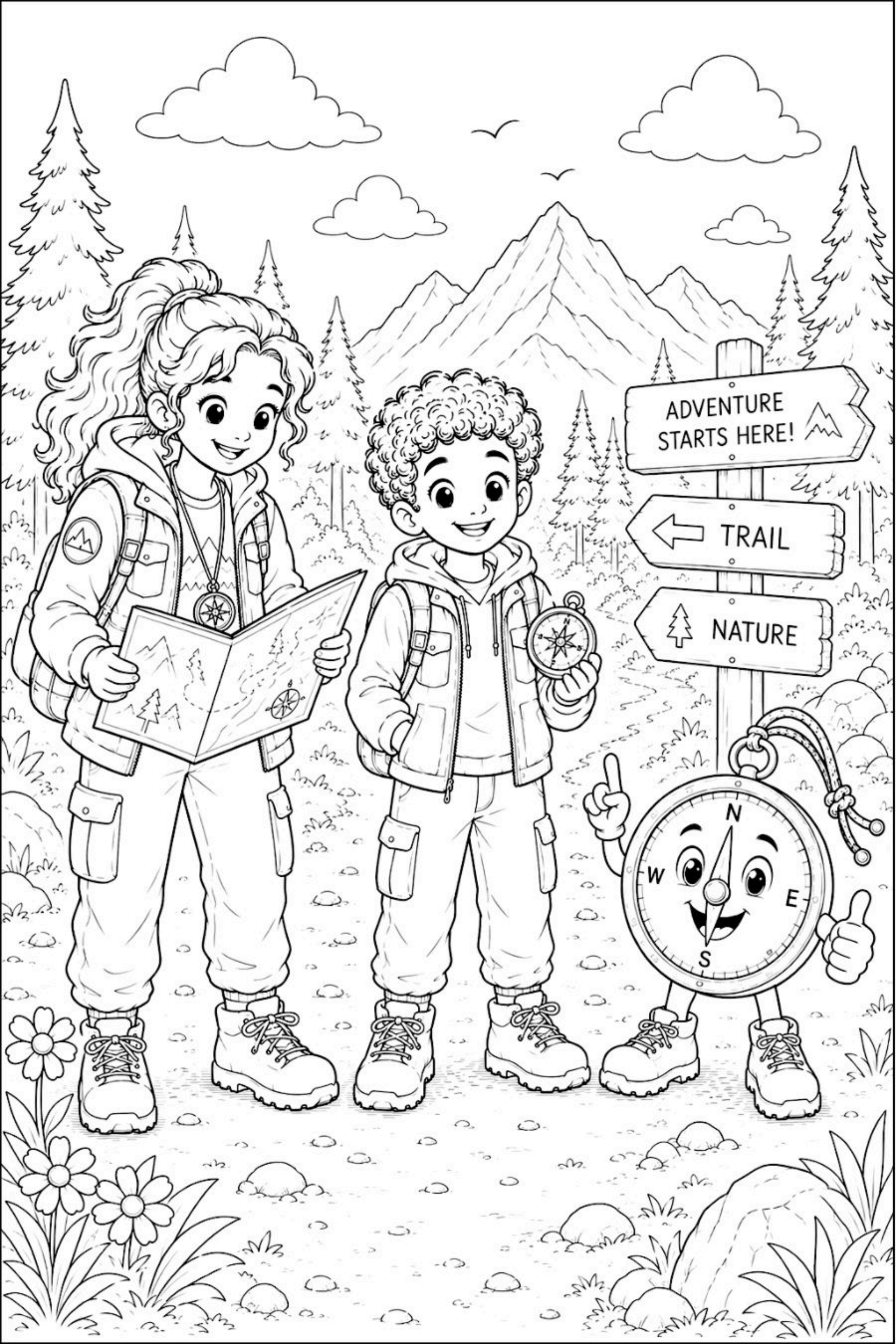
Draw your route here:

How I felt:

□ brave □ curious □ proud □ tired-but-happy

PART 3:

FUN COLORING


ADVENTURE STARTS HERE!
TRAIL
NATURE
N
W
E
S

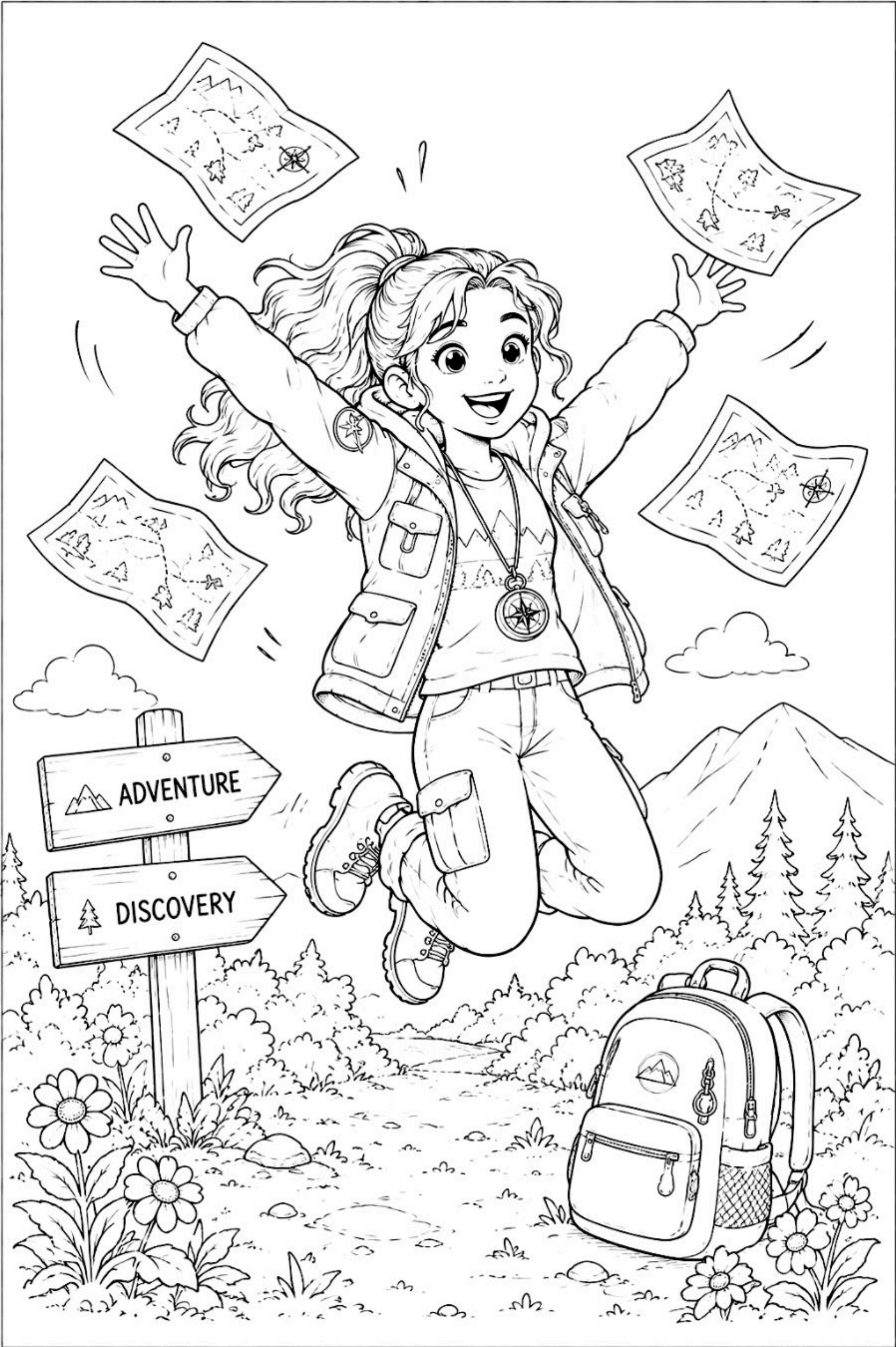

N
W
E
S
N
W
E
S


LOOKOUT
RIVER TRAIL


N
W
E
S
MOUNTAINS
FOREST
LAKE


VIEWPOINT
WATERFALL


N
W
E
S


ADVENTURE
DISCOVERY


N
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S


HOW COMPASS WORKS
N
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E
S
EXPLORE
LEARN
DISCOVER
N
W
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S
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W
E
S
COMPASS DESIGN
NEEDLE (MAGNETIZED)
DIAL (BEZEL)
BASEPLATE


N
W
E
S
N